

ANJUMAN COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY (ACET), NAGPUR

Department of Civil Engineering (Open Elective offered to all branches)

Affiliated to Rashtrasant Tukadoji Maharaj Nagpur University (RTMNU)

INTRODUCTION TO VASTU SHASTRA (BOE5T03)

B.Tech. | Semester V | Open Elective–III

UNIT – IV : VASTU FOR RESIDENTIAL BUILDINGS

Student Notes – written in simple language for students of all branches

Credits: 2	Lecture: 2 Hrs/Week	Internal: 30 University: 70	Unit-IV Hours: 7 CO4
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What you should be able to do after this unit (CO4)

CO4 – Analyse residential layouts based on Vastu principles. In plain terms: after this unit you should be able to look at a house plan and say whether each part – the entrance, living room, bedrooms, kitchen, bathroom, toilet, staircase, doors, windows and furniture – is placed correctly as per Vastu, and why.

Syllabus – Unit IV

Main entrance • Living room, bedroom, kitchen • Bathroom, toilet and staircase • Placement of doors, windows and furniture • Vastu do's and don'ts for residences.

A note before we start

This subject is an open elective, so you may be from any branch. These notes assume no earlier study of building or construction. Every technical word is explained in plain language, and there is a short glossary at the end.

In Units I to III you learned what Vastu is, the meaning of the directions, and how to choose a good plot. This unit is the most hands-on: how to arrange the rooms and things inside a home. One idea runs through the whole unit – keep the North-East light and open, keep the heavy and private rooms towards the South-West, put the kitchen (fire) in the South-East, and keep the centre of the house open.

1. What is this unit about?

So far you have learned to choose a plot. Now we place the rooms on it. “Vastu for residential buildings” means using simple direction rules to decide where the main door, the living room, the bedrooms, the kitchen and the service areas should go, and where to keep the furniture. The aim is a home that is bright, airy, comfortable and convenient to live in.

In simple words

If you remember just four things, remember these: the main door to the North, East or North-East; the kitchen in the South-East; the master bedroom in the South-West; and the toilet away from the North-East. Almost everything else follows from these.

2. The Main Entrance

The main door is treated as the “**mouth**” of the house – the place through which light, fresh air (and, in tradition, good energy) enter. So its direction is given a lot of importance.

- **Best directions:** North, East and North-East – the bright, cool sides of the house.
- **Acceptable with care:** South or West – usable, but the hot side should be shaded (a sunshade or verandah).
- **Avoid:** a door exactly at a corner; a door facing a wall, pole or big tree; and broken or creaking doors.
- **Always:** keep the entrance well-lit, clean and welcoming.



Fig. 4.1 Favourable directions for the main entrance

In simple words

The entrance is like the face of the house – it gives the first impression, and it is where you want good things to come in. So keep it bright, clean and free of obstructions.

3. Living Room and Bedrooms

3.1 Living room

- Best in the North, East or North-East – these are bright and welcoming for guests.
- Keep heavy furniture towards the South and West, and the North-East side lighter and more open.

3.2 Bedrooms

- **Master bedroom** – South-West. This is the most stable and private corner, suitable for the head of the family.
- **Children's / guest bedroom** – West or North-West; a child's study table is best facing East or North.
- **Sleeping direction** – sleep with the head towards the South (East is also fine). Avoid sleeping with the head towards the North.

In simple words

The South-West is the “anchor” corner of a home – heavy, stable and quiet – which is exactly what a master bedroom wants.

4. The Kitchen

The kitchen is linked with **fire (Agni)**, so its natural place is the **South-East**. If that is not possible, the North-West is the next choice.

- **Stove:** in the South-East corner; the cook faces East while cooking.
- **Sink / water:** towards the North-East side of the kitchen; keep the stove (fire) and the sink (water) apart.
- **Keep away from the toilet:** the kitchen should not be next to, above or below a toilet.



Fig. 4.3 Placing the bed and the kitchen

In simple words

Keeping fire (the stove) and water (the sink) apart is simply good kitchen sense – you don't want water splashing on the flame. And keeping the kitchen away from the toilet is basic hygiene.

5. Bathroom, Toilet and Staircase

5.1 Bathroom and toilet

- **Bathroom** – East or North-West is suitable; keep it well-lit and airy.
- **Toilet – good spots:** North-West, or the West / South-West side.
- **Toilet – avoid:** the North-East and the exact centre of the house.
- **Always:** keep bathrooms and toilets dry, clean and ventilated, with the door kept closed.

In simple words

The North-East is the clean, prayer corner of a home, so a toilet there feels as out of place as a dustbin in a temple – that is the simplest way to remember the rule.

5.2 Staircase

- **Best directions:** South, West or South-West – the heavier part of the house.
- **Avoid:** the North-East and the exact centre of the house.
- **Traditionally:** the stairs turn clockwise and the number of steps is often kept even.
- **Under the stairs:** do not place a kitchen or a prayer room there.

6. Doors, Windows and Furniture

6.1 Doors and windows

- Provide more doors and windows on the North and East sides for good light and air.
- Place windows opposite each other so that fresh air can flow through the room.
- Doors should open inward and clockwise, and should not creak; avoid three doors in one straight line.

In simple words

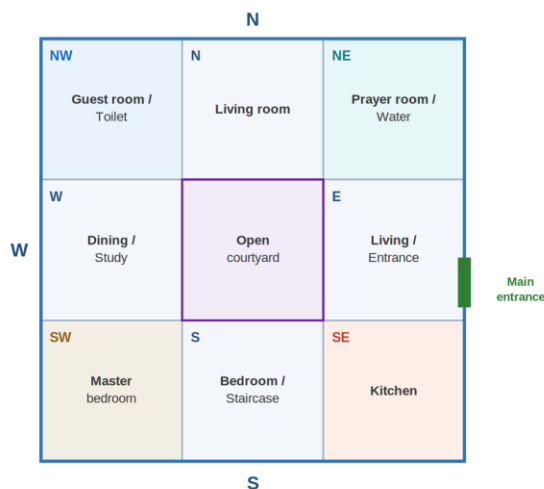
Windows on opposite walls work like a through-breeze on a hot day – open both and the whole room cools down. That is the real reason behind “cross-ventilation”.

6.2 Furniture

- **Heavy furniture and cupboards** – towards the South and West; keep the North-East corner of each room lighter.
- **Bed** – head to the South (East is fine); never to the North.
- **Study table** – placed so the person faces East or North.
- **Mirror** – on a North or East wall, and preferably not facing the bed.
- **Television / electrical items** – towards the South-East.

7. Reading a Sample Home Layout (how to “analyse” a plan)

The main skill of this unit (CO4) is to look at a house plan and judge it. The way to do this is simple: go room by room and check each one against the rules you have learned. The plan below is a good example.



Entrance to the E / N / NE • kitchen SE • master bedroom SW • toilet NW • centre open

Fig. 4.2 A sample Vastu layout for a home

Checking this plan room by room:

- Main entrance towards the East – good (bright, cool side).
- Prayer room and water in the North-East – good (kept light and open).
- Kitchen in the South-East – good (the fire direction).
- Master bedroom in the South-West – good (the stable, private corner).
- Toilet in the North-West, not the North-East – good.
- Centre of the house kept open – good.

In simple words

In an exam, “analyse this plan” means exactly this: take each room, say whether it is in a good Vastu position, and give the one-line reason.

8. Vastu Do's and Don'ts for a Home

Do's

- Keep the North-East open, clean and light.
- Put the kitchen in the South-East; the cook faces East.
- Keep the master bedroom in the South-West; sleep with the head to the South.

- Make more doors and windows on the North and East for light and air.
- Keep the centre of the house (Brahmasthan) open and clutter-free.
- Keep heavy furniture and storage towards the South and West.

Don'ts

- Don't put a toilet in the North-East or the centre of the house.
- Don't place the kitchen and toilet together (next to, above or below).
- Don't put a staircase or heavy weight in the North-East.
- Don't sleep with the head towards the North.
- Don't block the main entrance with a pole, tree or clutter.
- Don't leave dark, damp or cluttered corners in the house.

9. A Balanced View – Using Vastu Wisely

- **Ideas that are plain common sense:** morning light and fresh air, cross-ventilation, an open centre, clean and dry bathrooms, and keeping heavy things low and to the back. Anyone can understand these as comfort, health and safety.
- **Ideas that belong to tradition and belief:** lucky and unlucky directions, an even number of steps or doors, the link between sleeping direction and fortune, and prayers before building. These are respected as part of the culture, but are not proven by science.

The golden rule

Vastu is a helpful guideline, not a law. Safety rules and government (municipal) building rules always come first. If a Vastu idea clashes with a safety code or a municipal rule, the rule comes first. Respect Vastu where it does no harm, and follow the codes always.

Quick Revision (at a glance)

Key points to remember

- **Entrance:** front door to the North, East or North-East.
- **Living room:** North, East or North-East; heavy furniture to the S/W.
- **Master bedroom:** South-West; sleep with the head to the South.
- **Kitchen:** South-East; the cook faces East; stove and sink kept apart.
- **Toilet:** North-West or West – never in the North-East or the centre.
- **Staircase:** South, West or South-West; never in the North-East.
- **Doors & windows:** more on the North and East; place windows opposite for cross-ventilation.
- **Golden rule:** Vastu is a guideline; safety and municipal rules always come first.

Glossary of Terms (plain meanings)

Term	Simple meaning
Main entrance	The main door of the house; treated as the “mouth” through which light and air enter.
Orientation	The direction a building or room faces.
Ventilation	The free flow of fresh air through a room.
Cross-ventilation	Air flowing in one window and out of another on the opposite side.
Brahmasthan	The central zone of a house, kept open and clutter-free.
Agni	The Sanskrit word for fire; the kitchen is linked with the fire (South-East) direction.
Master bedroom	The main bedroom, best placed in the South-West.
Zoning / layout	Deciding which room goes in which direction.
Sunshade / chajja	A small projection above a window or door that keeps out the harsh sun.
Bye-laws	The local government (municipal) rules that every building must follow.

Practice Questions (CO4)

Short-answer / objective

1. In which directions should the main entrance of a house be placed?
2. Where should the kitchen be, and which way does the cook face?
3. Where is the best place for the master bedroom, and how should the bed face?
4. Which directions should be avoided for a toilet, and why?
5. Why are more windows placed on the North and East sides?

Long-answer

6. Explain the Vastu recommendations for the main entrance, living room and kitchen of a house.
7. Describe the placement of the bathroom, toilet and staircase as per Vastu.
8. Explain the placement of doors, windows and furniture in a Vastu-compliant home.
9. List any five Vastu do's and five don'ts for a residence.
10. Analyse a given house plan and comment on the position of each room as per Vastu.

Reference Books

1. B. Niranjan Babu, Vastu Shastra – Principles and Applications, Vastu Vijnan Prakashan, New Delhi.
2. Dr. Bhojraj Dwivedi, Vastu Shastra for Modern Homes, Diamond Books, New Delhi.
3. Ashok B. Jain, Practical Vastu Shastra, Sterling Publishers Pvt. Ltd., New Delhi.